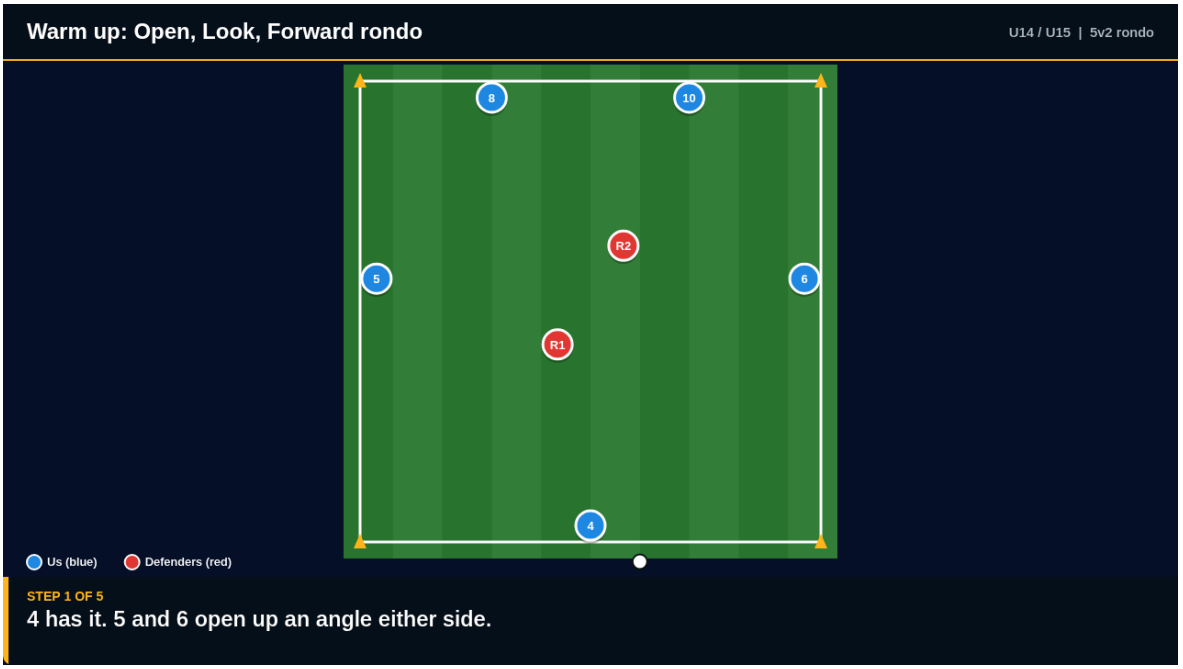
Week 1 session: Shape to receive, first pass forward

Block 3, week 1, Wednesday 4 November 2026. Theme: Show, Support, Stretch, then Spring. Cue: “Open, look, forward.”

For parents and players: Watch how the players move before the ball arrives: someone shows short, others give width, and the first pass goes forward. Players are shown by shirt number. Blue is us, red is the opposition.

Warm up: Open, Look, Forward rondo

5v2 rondo, 14m x 14m box. 4 cones, blue and red bibs, plenty of balls



SET UP

- 5 blues around a 14m box, 2 reds in the middle.
- Swap the reds every 60 seconds.

RULES

- Two touches.
- A pass that splits the two reds scores a point.

HOW IT STARTS

- Number 4 starts with the ball on the edge of the box
- Ball out or won: the red who won it swaps with the blue who lost it.

WHAT HAPPENS

1. 4 has it. 5 and 6 open up an angle either side.
2. 4 plays to 5. 5 is side on, on the half turn.
3. 5 scans and splits the two reds into 10.
4. 10 opens up and plays on to 6. Two touches.
5. 6 splits them again, back to 4. That is a point.

COACHING POINTS

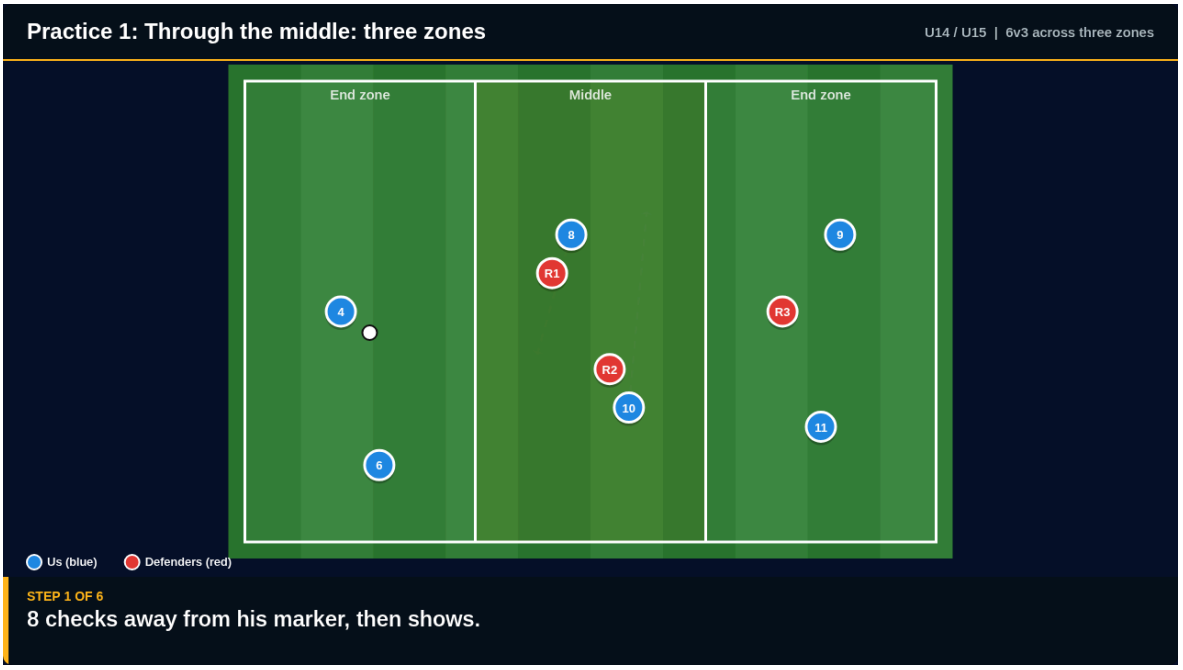
- Open your body: back foot to the ball.
- Look before it arrives, two looks.
- Pass through the middle when it is on.

MAKE IT HARDER

- One touch for a split pass.
- Make the box smaller, 12m.

Practice 1: Through the middle: three zones

6v3 across three zones, 36m x 24m, three zones of 12m. Cones for the zones, blue and red bibs



SET UP

- Three zones of 12m. Two blues in each end zone, two blues and two reds in the middle, one red in one end zone.

RULES

- The ball must go through the middle zone.
- Middle player: receive and play forward in two touches for a point.

HOW IT STARTS

- Number 4 starts with the ball in the end zone
- Reds win it: play it out to the coach and go again.
- Rotate the middle players every 2 minutes.

WHAT HAPPENS

1. 8 checks away from his marker, then shows.
2. 4 plays into 8. 8 is on the half turn.
3. First pass forward into 9.
4. SPRING: 8 runs beyond for the set. 10 drops in.
5. Now back the other way: 10 shows, receives, turns.
6. 10 plays forward into 6. Point.

COACHING POINTS

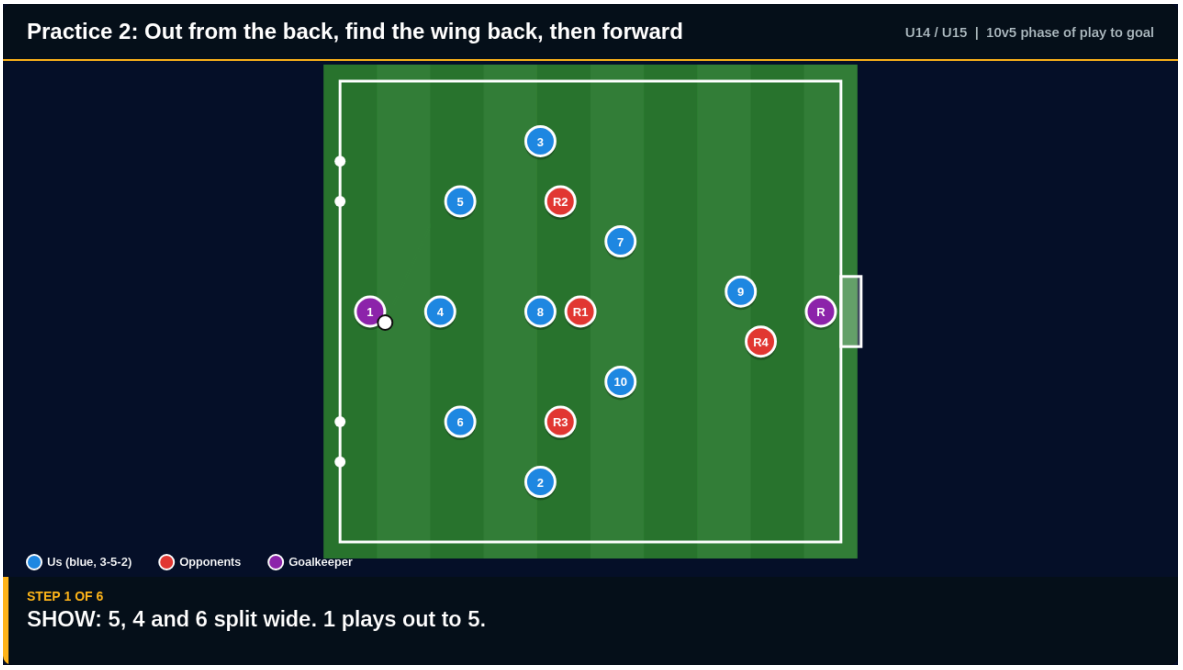
- Check away, then show.
- Receive side on, on the back foot.
- First look forward, then spring beyond.

MAKE IT HARDER

- Add a third red in the middle.
- One touch in the end zones.

Practice 2: Out from the back, find the wing back, then forward

10v5 phase of play to goal, Half pitch, 50m x 46m. Blue bibs for our 3-5-2, two small gates at our end for the reds



SET UP

- Half pitch with a full size goal. Our keeper and ten against five reds and their keeper.
- Two small gates at our end for the reds to counter into.

RULES

- Restart from our keeper each time.
- Reds win it: they can score in either small gate.

HOW IT STARTS

- Our keeper (1) starts with the ball
- Ball out: back to our keeper.

WHAT HAPPENS

1. SHOW: 5, 4 and 6 split wide. 1 plays out to 5.
2. Red presses 5. STRETCH: 3 stays wide and high, 7 shows inside.
3. 5 plays the line pass to 3.
4. 3 opens up and plays forward into 9.
5. SPRING: 7 runs beyond. 9 lays it off.
6. 7 shoots. Goal!

COACHING POINTS

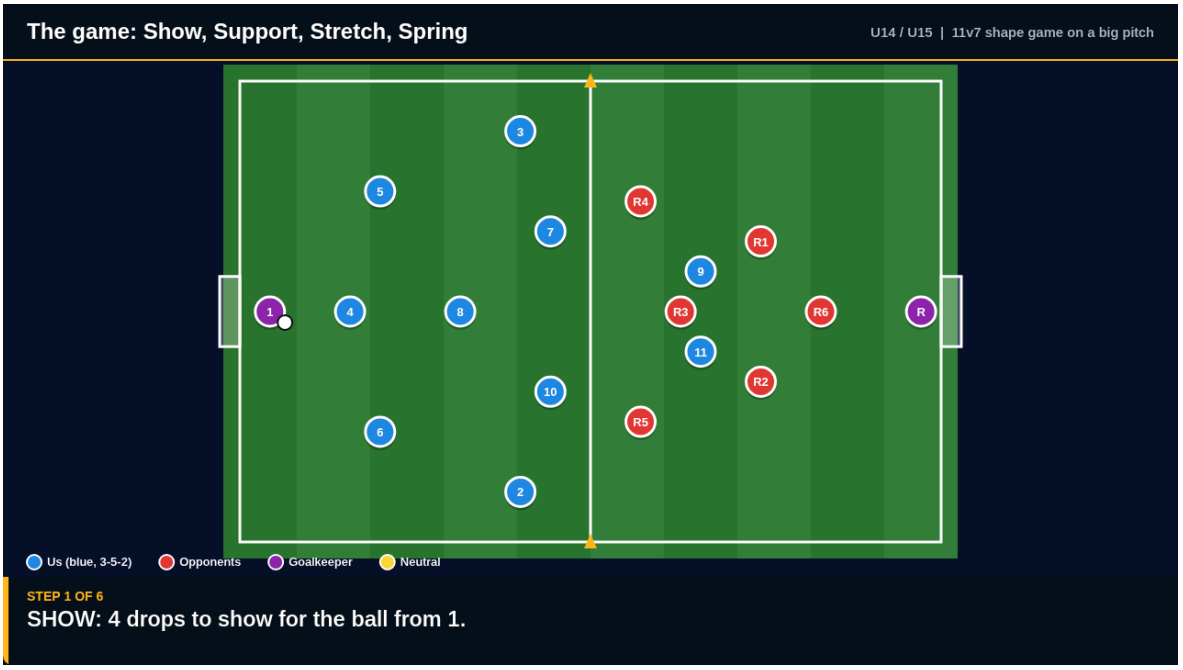
- Back three: split wide early.
- Wing backs: width and height.
- First look forward, then spring.

MAKE IT HARDER

- Add a sixth red to press.
- Centre backs have two touches.

The game: Show, Support, Stretch, Spring

11v7 shape game on a big pitch, 70m x 46m, a goal at each end. Blue bibs for our 3-5-2, Red for the opponents, cones on halfway



SET UP

- Our eleven in a 3-5-2 against six outfield players and a keeper.
- Halfway marked with cones.

RULES

- Restart from our keeper each time.
- A goal from a forward pass in the first three passes counts double.

HOW IT STARTS

- Our keeper (1) starts with the ball
- Ball out: back to our keeper.

WHAT HAPPENS

1. SHOW: 4 drops to show for the ball from 1.
2. SUPPORT: 8 and 5 give angles. STRETCH: 2 and 3 go wide and high.
3. 4 opens his body and plays forward to 7.
4. SPRING: 9 and 11 spin, 3 bombs on.
5. 3 crosses, 9 finishes.
6. Score!

COACHING POINTS

- Show early, before the ball is played.
- Open your body to face forward.
- Wing backs: width and height.
- First look is forward.

MAKE IT HARDER

- Opponents press with three.
- Limit our centre backs to two touches.

Watch the animated session with voice over in the Touchline family app. Wigan Junior Latics.